
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

UNIT 1 ASPECTS OF DRAMATIC TRAGEDY

Tuesday 16 May 2023

07:00 GMT

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an Oxford International AQA Examinations 12-page answer book.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.
- Remember to include, in both your answers, relevant comments on the authors' dramatic methods in the set texts you are studying.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Elizabethan and Jacobean tragedy

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Othello*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Othello and Iago
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 3 Scene 3**IAGO**

I will in Cassio's lodging lose this napkin,
And let him find it. Trifles light as air
Are to the jealous confirmations strong
As proofs of holy writ. This may do something.
The Moor already changes with my poison:
Dangerous conceits are in their natures poisons,
Which at the first are scarce found to distaste,
But, with a little act upon the blood,
Burn like the mines of Sulphur. I did say so.

Enter Othello

Look where he comes.
Not poppy, nor mandragora,
Nor all the drowsy syrups of the world
Shall ever medicine thee to that sweet sleep
Which thou owedst yesterday.

OTHELLO

Ha! ha! false to me?

IAGO

Why, how now, general? No more of that.

OTHELLO

Avaunt! be gone! Thou hast set me on the rack:
I swear 'tis better to be much abused
Than but to know't a little.

IAGO

How now, my lord!

OTHELLO

What sense had I in her stolen hours of lust?

I saw't not, thought it not – it harm'd not me;
 I slept the next night well, fed well, was free, and merry;
 I found not Cassio's kisses on her lips.
 He that is robb'd, not wanting what is stolen,
 Let him not know't, and he's not robbed at all.

IAGO

I am sorry to hear this.

OTHELLO

I had been happy, if the general camp,
 Pioneers and all, had tasted her sweet body,
 So I had nothing known. O, now for ever
 Farewell the tranquil mind; farewell content;
 Farewell the plumed troops, and the big wars
 That make ambition virtue – O, farewell!
 Farewell the neighing steed, and the shrill trump,
 The spirit-stirring drum, th'ear-piercing fife,
 The royal banner, and all quality,
 Pride, pomp and circumstance of glorious war;
 And, O you mortal engines, whose rude throats
 Th'immortal Jove's dead clamours counterfeit,
 Farewell! Othello's occupation's gone!

IAGO

Is't possible, my lord?

OTHELLO

Villain, be sure thou prove my love a whore!
 Be sure of it; give me the ocular proof;
[He seizes Iago by the throat]
 Or by the worth of man's eternal soul,
 Thou hadst been better have been born a dog
 Than answer my waked wrath!

IAGO

Is't come to this?

OTHELLO

Make me to see't; or, at the least, so prove it
 That the probation bear no hinge nor loop
 To hang a doubt on – or woe upon thy life!

IAGO

My noble lord –

OTHELLO

If thou dost slander her and torture me,
 Never pray more! Abandon all remorse,
 On horror's head horrors accumulate;
 Do deeds to make heaven weep, all earth amazed!
 For nothing canst thou to damnation add
 Greater than that.

or

0	2
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William Shakespeare: *King Lear*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Cordelia, Goneril and Regan
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 1 Scene 1

FRANCE

Fairest Cordelia, that art most rich, being poor;
Most choice, forsaken; and most loved, despised:
Thee and thy virtues here I seize upon.
Be it lawful, I take up what's cast away.
Gods, gods! 'Tis strange that from their cold'st neglect
My love should kindle to inflamed respect –
Thy dowerless daughter, King, thrown to my chance,
Is queen of us, of ours, and our fair France.
Not all the dukes in waterish Burgundy
Can buy this unprized precious maid of me. –
Bid them farewell, Cordelia, though unkind.
Thou lovest here, a better where to find.

KING LEAR

Thou hast her, France. Let her be thine, for we
Have no such daughter, nor shall ever see
That face of hers again. Therefore be gone,
Without our grace, our love, our benison. –
Come, noble Burgundy.

Flourish. Exeunt Lear and Burgundy, then Albany, Cornwall, Gloucester, Edmund and followers.

FRANCE [to Cordelia]

Bid farewell to your sisters.

CORDELIA

The jewels of our father, with washed eyes
Cordelia leaves you. I know you what you are,
And like a sister am most loath to call
Your faults as they are named. Use well our father,
To your professed bosoms I commit him.
But yet, alas, stood I within his grace
I would prefer him to a better place.
So farewell to you both.

REGAN

Prescribe not us our duties.

GONERIL

Let your study
Be to content your lord, who hath received you
At fortune's alms. You have obedience scanted,
And well are worth the worst that you have wanted.

CORDELIA

Time shall unfold what plaited cunning hides.
Who cover faults, at last shame them derides.
Well may you prosper!

FRANCE

Come, my fair Cordelia.

Exeunt France and Cordelia

GONERIL

Sister, it is not a little I have to say of what most
nearly appertains to us both. I think our father will hence
tonight.

REGAN

That's most certain, and with you. Next month with us.

GONERIL

You see how full of changes his age is. The observation
we have made of it hath not been little. He always
loved our sister most, and with what poor judgment he
hath now cast her off appears too gross.

REGAN

'Tis the infirmity of his age; yet he hath ever but
slenderly known himself.

GONERIL

The best and soundest of his time hath been but
rash; then must we look to receive from his age not alone
the imperfections of long-engrafted condition, but therewithal
the unruly waywardness that infirm and choleric
years bring with them.

REGAN

Such unconstant starts are we like to have from him
as this of Kent's banishment.

GONERIL

There is further compliment of leave-taking between
Burgundy and him. Pray you, let's hit together. If our
father carry authority with such dispositions as he bears,
this last surrender of his will but offend us.

This extract continues on the next page

REGAN

We shall further think on't.

GONERIL

We must do something, and i' the heat.

Exeunt

Turn over for the next question

or

0	3
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William Shakespeare: *Hamlet*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Hamlet, Horatio and Fortinbras
- Shakespeare's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 2

HAMLET

O, I die, Horatio.
The potent poison quite o'er-crows my spirit.
I cannot live to hear the news from England,
But I do prophesy th'election lights
On Fortinbras. He has my dying voice.
So tell him, with the occurrents, more and less,
Which have solicited - the rest is silence.

He gives a long sigh and dies

HORATIO

Now cracks a noble heart. Good night sweet prince,
And flights of angels sing thee to thy rest.
Why does the drum come hither?

Enter Fortinbras, the English Ambassadors, and soldiers with drum and colours

FORTINBRAS

Where is this sight?

HORATIO

What is it you would see?
If aught of woe or wonder, cease your search.

FORTINBRAS

This quarry cries on havoc. O proud Death,
What feast is toward in thine eternal cell,
That thou so many princes at a shot
So bloodily hast struck?

ENGLISH AMBASSADOR

The sight is dismal;
And our affairs from England come too late.
The ears are senseless that should give us hearing
To tell him his commandment is fulfilled:
That Rosencrantz and Guildenstern are dead.
Where should we have our thanks?

HORATIO

Not from his mouth,
 Had it th'ability of life to thank you;
 He never gave commandment for their death.
 But since, so jump upon this bloody question,
 You from the Polack wars, and you from England,
 Are here arrived, give order that these bodies
 High on a stage be placed to the view;
 And let me speak to th' yet unknowing world
 How these things came about. So shall you hear
 Of carnal, bloody, and unnatural acts,
 Of accidental judgments, casual slaughters,
 Of deaths put on by cunning and forced cause;
 And, in this upshot, purposes mistook
 Fallen on the inventors' heads. All this can I
 Truly deliver.

FORTINBRAS

Let us haste to hear it,
 And call the noblest to the audience.
 For me, with sorrow I embrace my fortune.
 I have some rights of memory in this kingdom,
 Which now to claim my vantage doth invite me.

HORATIO

Of that I shall have also cause to speak,
 And from his mouth whose voice will draw on more.
 But let this same be presently performed,
 Even while men's minds are wild, lest more mischance
 On plots and errors happen.

FORTINBRAS

Let four captains
 Bear Hamlet like a soldier to the stage;
 For he was likely, had he been put on,
 To have proved most royally; and, for his passage,
 The soldiers' music and the rites of war
 Speak loudly for him.
 Take up the bodies. Such a sight as this
 Becomes the field, but here shows much amiss.
 Go, bid the soldiers shoot.

A dead march. Exeunt, bearing off the bodies, after the which a peal of ordnance is shot off

or

0	4
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Christopher Marlowe: *Doctor Faustus*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Faustus
- Marlowe's use of dramatic language
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 5 Scene 2

FAUSTUS

O Faustus,

Now hast thou but one bare hour to live,
And then thou must be damned perpetually.
Stand still, you ever-moving spheres of heaven,
That time may cease and midnight never come!
Fair Nature's eye, rise, rise again, and make
Perpetual day; or let this hour be but
A year, a month, a week, a natural day,
That Faustus may repent and save his soul!
O lente, lente currite, noctis equi!
The stars move still; time runs; the clock will strike;
The devil will come, and Faustus must be damned.
O, I'll leap up to heaven! Who pulls me down?
One drop of blood will save me. O my Christ!
Rend not my heart for naming of my Christ!
Yet will I call on him. O, spare me, Lucifer!
Where is it now? 'Tis gone;
And, see, a threat'ning arm, an angry brow.
Mountains and hills, come, come and fall on me,
And hide me from the heavy wrath of heaven!
No? Then will I headlong run into the earth.
Gape, earth! O, no, it will not harbour me.
You stars that reigned at my nativity,
Whose influence hath allotted death and hell,
Now draw up Faustus, like a foggy mist,
Into the entrails of yon labouring cloud,
That when you vomit forth into the air,
My limbs may issue from your smoky mouths,
But let my soul mount and ascend to heaven.

[The watch strikes]

O, half the hour is past! 'Twill all be past anon.
O, if my soul must suffer for my sin,
Impose some end to my incessant pain.
Let Faustus live in hell a thousand years,
A hundred thousand, and at last be saved!
No end is limited to damned souls.
Why wert thou not a creature wanting soul?

Or why is this immortal that thou hast?
O, Pythagoras' *metempsychosis*, were that true,
This soul should fly from me, and I be changed
Into some brutish beast.

All beasts are happy, for, when they die,
Their souls are soon dissolved in elements;
But mine must live still to be plagued in hell.
Curst be the parents that engendered me!
No, Faustus, curse thyself. Curse Lucifer
That hath deprived thee of the joys of heaven.

[*The clock strikes twelve*]

It strikes, it strikes! Now, body, turn to air,
Or Lucifer will bear thee quick to hell.
O soul, be changed into small waterdrops,
And fall into the ocean, ne'er be found!

[*Thunder, and enter the devils*]

O, mercy, heaven! look not so fierce on me!
Adders and serpents, let me breathe a while!
Ugly hell, gape not. Come not, Lucifer!
I'll burn my books! O, Mephistopheles!

Exeunt

Turn over for the next question

or

0	5
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John Webster: *The Duchess of Malfi*

Explore the significance of the aspects of dramatic tragedy in the following passage in relation to the play as a whole.

You should consider the following in your answer:

- the presentation of Bosola and Ferdinand
- Webster's use of dialogue
- the dramatic setting and action
- other relevant aspects of dramatic tragedy.

[25 marks]

Act 4 Scene 2

BOSOLA

Why, fare thee well.
 Your brother and yourself are worthy men;
 You have a pair of hearts are hollow graves,
 Rotten, and rotting others; and your vengeance,
 Like two chained-bullets, still goes arm in arm:
 You may be brothers; for treason, like the plague,
 Doth take much in a blood. I stand like one
 That long hath ta'en a sweet and golden dream:
 I am angry with myself, now that I wake.

FERDINAND

Get thee into some unknown part o' th' world,
 That I may never see thee.

BOSOLA

Let me know
 Wherefore I should be thus neglected. Sir,
 I served your tyranny, and rather strove
 To satisfy yourself than all the world;
 And though I loathed the evil, yet I loved
 You that did counsel it; and rather sought
 To appear a true servant than an honest man.

FERDINAND

I'll go hunt the badger by owl-light:
 'Tis a deed of darkness.

Exit

BOSOLA

He's much distracted. Off, my painted honour!
 While with vain hopes our faculties we tire,
 We seem to sweat in ice, and freeze in fire.
 What would I do, were this to do again?
 I would not change my peace of conscience
 For all the wealth of Europe. She stirs; here's life.
 Return, fair soul, from darkness, and lead mine

Out of this sensible hell. She's warm, she breathes.
 Upon thy pale lips I will melt my heart
 To store them with fresh colour. Who's there?
 Some cordial drink! Alas, I dare not call:
 So pity would destroy pity; her eye opes,
 And heaven in it seems to ope, that late was shut,
 To take me up to mercy.

DUCHESS

Antonio!

BOSOLA

Yes, madam, he is living;
 The dead bodies you saw were but feigned statues.
 He's reconciled to your brothers; the Pope hath wrought
 The atonement.

DUCHESS

Mercy

She dies.

BOSOLA

O, she's gone again; there the cords of life broke.
 O sacred innocence, that sweetly sleeps
 On turtles' feathers, whilst a guilty conscience
 Is a black register, wherein is writ
 All our good deeds and bad, a perspective
 That shows us hell. That we cannot be suffered
 To do good when we have a mind to it!
 [*He weeps*] This is manly sorrow;
 These tears, I am very certain, never grew
 In my mother's milk. My estate is sunk
 Below the degree of fear; where were
 These penitent fountains while she was living?
 O, they were frozen up. Here is a sight
 As direful to my soul as is the sword
 Unto a wretch hath slain his father. Come,
 I 'll bear thee hence,
 And execute thy last will; that's deliver
 Thy body to the reverend dispose
 Of some good women; that the cruel tyrant
 Shall not deny me. Then I'll post to Milan,
 Where somewhat I will speedily enact
 Worth my dejection.

Exit [with the body]

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Later dramatic tragedies

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	6
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Arthur Miller: *Death of a Salesman*

'The tragedy of *Death of a Salesman* is mainly caused by the male characters' loss of confidence in their own masculinity.'

Discuss this view of the play.

[25 marks]

or

0	7
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Tennessee Williams: *A Streetcar Named Desire*

'The tragedy of *A Streetcar Named Desire* is a tragedy based on a clash between two cultures. A brutal and competitive culture triumphs over a more elegant and sophisticated one.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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Henrik Ibsen: *Hedda Gabler*

'George Tesman is essentially a failure. He is too ridiculous a figure to have any tragic impact within the play.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the way Tesman is presented in the tragedy of *Hedda Gabler*?

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Samuel Beckett: *Waiting for Godot*

'*Waiting for Godot* is a tragedy of imprisonment where any sort of freedom is presented as an impossibility.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

or

1	0
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Brian Friel: *Translations*

'*Translations* is a play about language. Language lies at the heart of the tragedy.'

How far do you agree with this view of the play?

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

There are no questions printed on this page

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